What made the strong work strong

- **One colour owns the surface.** Extract No. 01 is terracotta, the candles are oxblood, navy, forest and ochre, and the earlier tea was teal. Every surface commits to one saturated colour.
- **The flower is painted out of that colour.** Its tepals are tints of the ground, so it glows from inside the colour rather than sitting on top of it. That is why the extract and teal flowers had presence.
- **Scale and crop.** One flower, very large, cut by the edge, the way VELVET and HARMONY are cut on the candles. Nothing is small and evenly spread.
- **Contrast.** A pale, luminous subject on a deep ground, and gold on dark.
- **What the Sage foliage lost.** It is beige on beige, many shapes of equal weight, and the flower is the same value as the leaves around it. The rendering is tidy, but nothing leads.
- **What was wrong with the earlier teal.** The blur was everywhere, so nothing was in focus. The cartoon-bright green leaves fought the flower. The layout crowded the art.
- **The method for all three concepts.** Same 25-bag carton, same generator, same type layout, same flat light and the same camera. The earlier teal is included as a benchmark, built as it was; its older type layout differs.

SAME CARTON, SAME TYPE, SAME LIGHT, SAME CAMERA

The three directions and the benchmark



BENCHMARK · THE EARLIER TEAL



A · ATMOSPHERIC



B · GRAPHIC

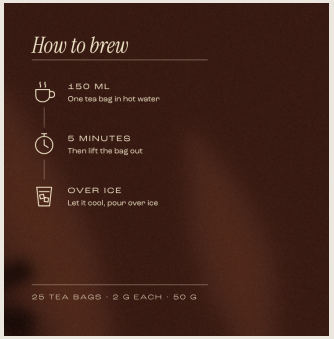


C · THE EXTRACT SYSTEM

A · Atmospheric







- **The idea.** Looking into a cup of black tea toward the light. The whole carton is the colour of the brewed tea, and one flower is lit from within in cream and amber.
- **Depth by planes, like a lens.** A large bloom behind is out of focus, the hero is sharp, and the cured pods in front are out of focus. The softness has a reason and a place; it is not spread over everything.
- **What it gives the brand.** The most atmosphere and the most luxury. Gold on mahogany is the richest pairing in the range.
- **Risks.** Brown reads as coffee or chocolate before tea. Variants all stay in browns, so they separate less well. Soft tones on a dark flood need a good press to avoid banding and muddy shadows.

B · Graphic







- **The idea.** A tea estate at first light, made as a print. The forms are cut and simplified: a large flower in flat cream, three tea leaves, two slim pods, and a low ochre sun behind. Fine cream line work only where it adds character: two leaves' veins and the petal midribs.
- **What it gives the brand.** The most recognisable shelf mark. The sun is an ownable device, and its colour can change per variant. It shares the candles' confidence: flat colour and big shapes.
- **Printing.** The best of the three. Four flat spot colours on a dark flood, no soft tones to hold, and it also works as a screen print or on a kraft pouch.
- **Risks.** It is a different visual language from the soft flowers on the extracts and soaps. Executed loosely, flat botanical illustration drifts toward craft or indie rather than premium.

C · The extract system





- **The idea.** The extract label, applied to the tea. A cream type panel and a full-height colour field, joined by a straight edge exactly as on the bottles. The flower is painted out of the field's own teal and cropped by the edge.
- **Corrected from the earlier teal.** One hero flower in focus with a soft echo behind it. The leaves are dark teal shapes, not bright green. The pods are low. The art gets its own field, so the type no longer crowds it.
- **What it gives the brand.** It is unmistakably Vanilla Shop at a glance, and it makes tea a sibling of the extracts: No. 01 red, No. 02 gold, No. 03 green, tea teal. Variants change only the field colour.
- **Risks.** It is the least new of the three, and the cream half is quiet. Its strength is consistency, not surprise.

AS BUILT EARLIER, FOR COMPARISON

Benchmark · the earlier teal



- **What was right.** Colour, presence, and the flower glowing out of the teal: the extract technique.
- **What held it back.** Blur everywhere, so the flower never resolves. The bright green leaves compete with it. The spec block, name and logos crowd the art, and the composition is centred and static.
- **Honest verdict.** It was stronger than any of the cream foliage versions. C keeps everything that worked about it and corrects what didn't.

The Vanilla Shop — the family, with Vanilla Tea A · Atmospheric









The Vanilla Shop — the family, with Vanilla Tea B · Graphic









The Vanilla Shop — the family, with Vanilla Tea C · The extract system









The Vanilla Shop — the family, with Vanilla Tea Benchmark · the earlier teal









SCORED 1–5, BY EYE ON THE BOARDS; A JUDGEMENT, NOT A MEASUREMENT

Evaluation

CRITERION	EARLIER TEAL	A · ATMOSPHERIC	B · GRAPHIC	C · EXTRACT SYSTEM
Artistic quality and originality	3	4	4	4
Premium perception	3	5	3	4
Relationship to the family	4	3	3	5
Visual impact and recognisability	3	4	5	4
Suitability for printing	3	3	5	4
Adaptability across variants and formats	4	3	5	5
Total	**20**	**22**	**25**	**26**

RECOMMENDATION

Develop C. It scores highest, one point ahead of B, and wins the criterion this brief weighs most: belonging to the family. Put it beside the bottles and it reads as the same house with no explanation. It keeps what made the earlier teal good, and it is ready for variants and the pouch with no new rules.

From A, C should borrow the deliberate depth: the sharp hero with a soft echo, and the pods as an out-of-focus foreground. Atmosphere comes from those planes, not from blur everywhere.

THE HONEST ALTERNATIVES

B is the bolder bet. It is the most recognisable and the easiest to print. Choose it if tea should stand apart as its own line, the way the candles do with their big type.

A is the most beautiful single object, but brown says coffee first, and it would not stretch well across variants.

And plainly: the earlier teal artwork was stronger than the recent Sage foliage. The cream foliage route should not continue.